Garima Singh

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EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Management Indore, Madhya Pradesh, India
Ph.D. Finance & Accounting, *expected* March 2027
Dissertation Committee: Prof. Kiran K. Kumar (Chair), Prof. Surya Bhushan Kumar, Prof. Mehul Raithatha

Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh, India
Master of Commerce (Finance), September 2021

Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh, India
Bachelor of Commerce (Honours in Finance), May 2019

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Junior Research Fellowship (JRF) | University Grants Commission, India, 2022
Nationally competitive fellowship awarded by UGC; qualifies holders for doctoral research funding.

Third Place, Behavioural Policy Hacks 2021 | London School of Economics & Government of Lithuania, 2021
Designed behavioural interventions to transform social norms around intimate partner violence in Lithuania.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Energy Economics, Household Finance, Corporate Finance, Capital Markets, Social Finance and Sustainable Development

WORKING PAPERS

"Beyond Access: Energy Affordability, Financial Inclusion and Household Behaviour in India." With Prof. Kiran K. Kumar. January 2026.

This paper revisits the measurement of household energy poverty by emphasising its affordability dimension and examining the role of financial inclusion (FI) in mitigating energy poverty among Indian households. Using data from the Consumer Pyramids Household Survey (CPHS) by CMIE, we construct a novel energy poverty measure capturing both accessibility and affordability. We use pooled OLS and an instrumental variable (IV) approach to address endogeneity. Results show that higher FI significantly reduces energy poverty, with stronger effects for female-headed, rural, and marginalised-caste households. We further show that household financial expectations moderate the FI–energy poverty relationship, and identify poverty reduction and educational investment as key transmission channels.

"Does Energy Development Drive Social Progress?" With Prof. Kiran K. Kumar. March 2026.

This study examines how energy development affects social progress using data from the Social Progress Imperative across 119 countries. We construct a holistic Energy Development Index (EDI) via Principal Component Analysis, capturing energy availability, affordability, and modernity. Using fixed-effects panel regressions and two-stage least squares, by instrumenting the EDI with night-time satellite light intensity, we find energy development robustly drives all three SPI dimensions: Basic Human Needs, Foundations of

Wellbeing, and Opportunity. Energy import dependence moderates these gains, with high-import nations achieving smaller social returns. Fuel composition also matters non-linearly: bioenergy shows an inverted-U relationship with social progress, while renewables follow a U-shaped path reflecting transitional costs and long-run developmental dividends. These findings reframe energy policy as social development policy.

"Investor Attention and Stock Price Crash Risk: Role of Sentiment and Governance." June 2024.

This study investigates the relationship between firm-specific investor attention, market sentiment, and stock price crash risk in the Indian market. Using the Google Search Volume Index (GSVI) as a proxy for retail investor attention and the Consumer Confidence Index (CCI) for market sentiment, the analysis employs multivariate regression models to assess their influence on two crash risk measures: Negative Conditional Skewness (NCSKEW) and Down-to-Up Volatility (DUVOL). Results indicate that increased firm-specific attention significantly reduces future crash risk, while market sentiment independently increases it. Board size modestly mitigates the impact of investor attention on crash risk.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

"*AI Integration and Corporate Net-Zero Commitments: Are Firms Slowing Their Climate Targets?*" Started February 2026.

"*Climate Litigation Risk and Firm Value: Evidence from Corporate Supply Chains.*" Started March 2026.

"*BRSR Textual Disclosure Quality and Market Reactions: Evidence from Indian Listed Firms.*" Started May 2026.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

World Finance Conference, University of Limerick, Ireland, 2026. "Beyond Access: Energy Affordability, Financial Inclusion and Household Behaviour in India."
Research Symposium on Finance and Economics (RSFE) 2026, Krea University, "Does Energy Development Drive Social Progress?"
IEG Annual Conference on Finance and Markets, 2026. "Beyond Access: Energy Affordability, Financial Inclusion and Household Behaviour in India."
XLRI Global Banking and Finance Conference, 2026. "Beyond Access: Energy Affordability, Financial Inclusion and Household Behaviour in India."
IIM Calcutta Finance Research Conference (IIMCFRC), 2025. "Beyond Access: Energy Affordability, Financial Inclusion and Household Behaviour in India."
19th ISDSI Global Conference, IMI Kolkata, 2025. "Beyond Access: Energy Affordability, Financial Inclusion and Household Behaviour in India"
22nd AIMS International Conference on Management, IIM Kozhikode, 2025. "Investor Attention and Stock Price Crash Risk: Role of Sentiment and Governance."

PROFESSIONAL AND UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Representative, CERE Conference, IIM Indore
Led registration team and helpdesk for the annual conference.

Cultural Committee Representative (DPM), IIM Indore
Organised student festivals and community events.

Member, Editorial Board, Finance and Economics Think Council, BHU
Wrote and edited articles for student- led finance and economics club

Volunteer Manager, Robin Hood Army, Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh
Coordinated volunteers for food distribution drives.

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

MBA: Finance I, Post Graduate Programme in Management, IIM Indore
Delivered weekly tutorials, facilitated class participation, and supported the instructor in course administration for a cohort of approximately 160 MBA students across two sections.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. Saumya Ranjan Dash, IIM Indore, 2023–2024
Assisted on projects spanning corporate governance, stock price crash risk, and climate finance.
Tasks included: constructing comprehensive proxy datasets for CEO and board characteristics; conducting and summarising literature reviews on upper echelon theory, IPO mispricing, mutual fund management, earnings management, and terrorism's effects on stock prices; compiling panel data on stock returns and macroeconomic indicators; building Excel-based tools for recording climate risk measures; and learning and applying ImageJ software to measure facial width-to-height ratios.
Cumulative research contribution exceeded 130 hours across Terms III, IV, and V.

Computer Skills: Stata, Excel, EViews, R, Python (Basic)

CERTIFICATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

Advanced Econometric Workshop | IIT Indore, July 2024

Workshop on Frontiers in Health Economics | BITS Pilani, September 2025

Doctoral Participant-Centered Learning (DPCL) Workshop | Harvard Business School, May 2026
Nominated by Indian Institute of Management Indore to attend this selective doctoral pedagogy programme.

REFERENCES AND DISSERTATION COMMITTEE

Prof. Kiran K. Kumar (Chair)
Professor of Finance and Accounting, Indian Institute of Management Indore
Email: kirankumar@iimidr.ac.in

Prof. Surya Bhushan Kumar
Assistant professor of Finance and Accounting, Indian Institute of Management Indore
Email: suryak@iimidr.ac.in

Prof. Mehul Raithatha
Professor of Finance and Accounting, Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad
Email: mehulr@iima.ac.in